

THE LAST THREE PRISONERS OF SPANDAU

When recently 300 metres from the prison of Spandau in Berlin a new building was set up, two photo-reporters, disguised as bricklayers, smuggled their powerful telescopic camera into the scaffolding. For three weeks they took turns peering through the camera in the hope of photographing the last three of Hitler's henchmen still imprisoned there. They are Rudolph Hess, the Führer's former Deputy, Albert Speer, his Minister for Armaments, and the Reich Youth Leader, Baldur von Schirach. Hess is serving a life sentence, the other two prisoners twenty years each.

Originally there were seven prisoners; three were released before the completion of their sentences because of ill health - all are now dead. One other was released on the completion of a year sentence. To look after the three men, whose every move is noted by the Allied guards, costs the Government of West Berlin £30,000 per year. There are 11 cooks, 14 kitchen hands, 10 warders, three porters, two washerwomen and a boilerman. In addition, the salaries of the allied officials who run the jail add to the annual cost. The jail itself could hold more than 1,000 men - but its empty spaces only emphasise the loneliness of the three men who are serving the penalty for their crimes.

In view of the forthcoming trial of Adolf Eichmann in Jerusalem these unique photographs are of very special interest. They are the first pictures for many years to show Hitler's old guard doing time. It is, of course, strictly forbidden to take photographs inside the prison itself.

Please acknowledge.
Photographs by SALLBIN AND BIER.
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